

DO ENGLISH WITH BRIAN

Sound More Natural

Hong — Class 1



Warm-up · 10 Expressions · Grammar · Roleplay

WARM-UP

Let's Just Talk

First class! No pressure — let's just chat and get comfortable.



How are you today? Tell me a little about yourself.



What have you been watching lately? Any favorites?



The Notebook, Titanic — what do you love about romance movies?

Ways to Open a Sentence

1

I'm not gonna lie, ~

= honestly / for real

e.g. *I'm not gonna lie, that movie made me cry.*

2

To be honest, ~

= speaking truthfully

e.g. *To be honest, I'm a little nervous today.*

3

I feel like ~

= a softer, natural 'I think'

e.g. *I feel like this song fits the mood.*

4

I'm kind of into ~

= I'm getting interested in it

e.g. *I'm kind of into old romance films.*

5

I've been meaning to ~

= I've wanted to, but haven't yet

e.g. *I've been meaning to watch that show.*

Ways to React & Respond

6

That makes sense.

= I understand / that's logical

e.g. *"That's why she left." "That makes sense."*

7

It depends.

= the answer changes with the situation

e.g. *"Do you like action movies?" "It depends."*

8

It's not a big deal.

= it's not important; don't worry

e.g. *Don't stress — it's not a big deal.*

9

You have no idea.

= you can't imagine how much

e.g. *"Was it good?" "You have no idea."*

10

I'm still getting used to ~

= not fully comfortable with it yet

e.g. *I'm still getting used to speaking English.*

-ing or to? (after into / used to / meaning)

into + V-ing

After **into**, always add **-ing**.

- I'm **into cooking**.
- What are you **into**?
- She's **into hiking**.

used to + V-ing

After **(get) used to**, also **-ing**.

- I'm getting **used to working** here.
- He's not **used to waking** up early.
- You'll **get used to speaking** soon.

meaning + TO + verb

After **been meaning**, use **to + verb**.

- I've been meaning **to call** you.
- I've been meaning **to watch** it.
- She's been meaning **to start** yoga.

MINI ROLEPLAY

Set the scene — you make the lines

SCENE 1

Talk about what you're watching

Brian asks what you've been watching lately. Keep the chat going!

USE THESE

I'm kind of into ~

I've been meaning to ~

You have no idea.

SCENE 2

Talk about something new you started

A new hobby, a class, or learning English — tell Brian how it's going.

USE THESE

To be honest, ~

I'm still getting used to ~

It's not a big deal.

Fill in the blanks

1

1. Honestly speaking...

start the sentence another way

e.g. _____, I was really nervous. (3 words)

2

2. I enjoy / I'm interested in...

use a natural opener

e.g. I'm kind of _____ K-dramas. (1 word)

3

3. -ing or to?

after 'into'

e.g. I'm into _____ (cook).

4

4. -ing or to?

after 'been meaning'

e.g. I've been meaning _____ (call) you.

5

5. React naturally

"Was the movie good?"

e.g. "You have _____." (2 words)

Great job today, Hong!

You already sound more natural! Practice these with the Listen & Shadow file — see you next class.

